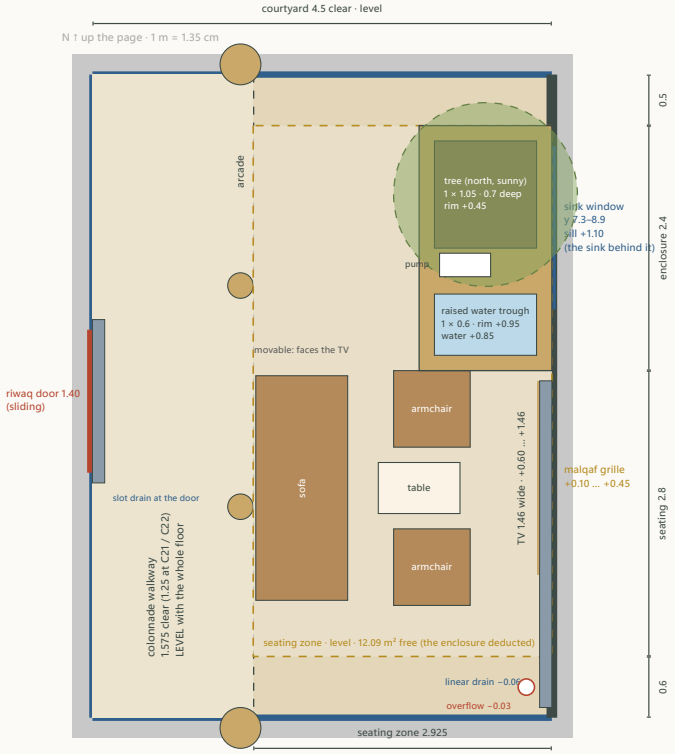
Courtyard layout · REVISED 3 Nov 2026 · a level floor, movable furniture, the enclosure on the kitchen wall in front of the sink window · Taif / Palm House V8.2

Owner decisions 3 Nov 2026 (the V8.0 layout of 1 Nov 2026 revised: no step, no built-in benches, the enclosure moved east, the TV moved south) · clear dimensions between finished faces · the data in `3d/character.yaml` `courtyard_layout` (built in the 3D) and `studies/air_system.typ` (the grille) · every size assumed; nothing here is for construction



1 · The level floor and the paths

- **Courtyard:** 4.5 × 6.3 m between the finished faces (28.35 m²), **the whole floor LEVEL** (owner, 3 Nov 2026: no step anywhere; the V8.0 sunken seating is withdrawn): the colonnade walkway (1.575 m clear to the soffit edge, 1.25 at C21 / C22), the seating zone and the three cleaning strips at the glass are one surface with gentle falls (page 2). Honey-light stone, slip-resistant, no nosing, no riser light.
- **Paths kept free:** the colonnade walkway (nothing west of the soffit edge x 5.925); the riwaq door (sliding 1.40) and the living's glass (a 0.6 m strip); the women's majlis glass (a 0.5 m strip, **the north side freed**: nothing stands in front of the majlis glass any more); cleaning access along the kitchen wall between the enclosure and the chairs (0.8 m in front of the grille).

2 · Movable furniture for 4–6, facing the TV

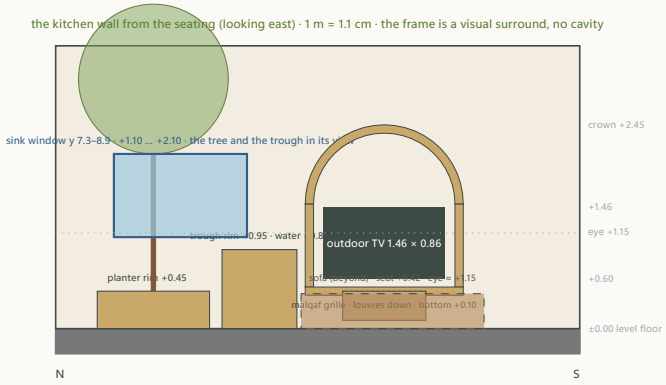
- **Modern movable pieces** (the owner chooses them): a **3-seat sofa** 2.2 × 0.9 with its back to the colonnade edge facing the TV on the east wall, **two armchairs** beside the low **table** 0.8 × 0.5 (meals, coffee): **5 seats**, 6 with two stools; everything can be moved for a big meal or cleaning. Outdoor-rated fabrics, cushions stored in the hospitality kitchen's cupboard.
- **Seating area gained:** the level zone east of the soffit edge from the north strip to the south strip is 15.21 m²; less the enclosure (3.12 m²) **12.09 m² free**, against 10.53 m² in the sunken pit: **+1.56 m² (+15 %)**; and the colonnade strip (9.92 m²) is now at the same level, so the whole 28.35 m² floor is one usable surface.

3 · The enclosure on the kitchen wall: the view from the sink

- **One honey-stone box against the kitchen wall** x 7.55–8.85, y 7.1–9.5 (1.3 × 2.4 outside, walls 0.15), **directly in front of the sink window** (y 7.3–8.9, sill +1.10); 0.5 m off the women's majlis glass.
- **The planting basin (north, sunny part):** 1 × 1.05 inside, 0.7 deep, rim +0.45 (a ledge); the tree (**Laurus nobilis** standard or clipped **Ficus nitida**, a Taif nursery decides), stem 2, crown Ø1.8 centred 3 m: its crown fills the window's view (head +2.10) and shades the north part of the wall.
- **The water (south part): a RAISED trough** 1 × 0.6 inside, rim **+0.95** (below the sill +1.10), water +0.85, a laminar lip in honey stone on the wall side at +1.05 (no spray); **seen from the sink:** the sight line of a person at the sink (eye +1.60, 0.6 m behind the wall) passes the sill and reaches +0.28 at the trough's far rim (1.15 m out): the rim, the water and the lip are in view, the tree beside them. The pump and filter chamber in the divider between the two basins (cover at the rim); both basins tanked separately, each with its own drain to the rain system.

Study checks passed (9)

4 · The kitchen wall from the seating (the enclosure, the TV, the grille) · 5 · Drainage on a level floor · 6 · Dimensions



4 · The TV, its frame and the grille

- **The TV:** an **outdoor-rated** set (65″ class, ≈ 1.46 × 0.86 m; the final size, bracket, ventilation and clearances **per the chosen model**), **moved south along the kitchen wall** to y 9.82–11.28 (centre y 10.55, 0.32 m south of the enclosure), bottom +0.60, top +1.46: the centre at +1.03 for a seated eye ≈ +1.15 on a sofa at 2.0–2.5 m.
- **The frame:** honey stone, a visual surround only (jambs and a semicircular head, band 0.1, proud 0.06, inner width 1.7, springing +1.50, crown +2.45); 0.7 m of solid wall between the sink window and the frame.
- **The grille** (`studies/air_system.typ`): below the TV, y 10.05–11.05, +0.10 … +0.45: its **bottom 0.1 m above the level floor** (not in a pit any more), 0.15 m under the TV, 0.8 m of free floor in front of it (the chairs stand west of x 8.05), the louvre sending the breeze along the floor to the seating; removable for cleaning.

5 · Drainage on a level floor

- **Falls:** the inside floors ±0.00; the courtyard finish at the three glass lines and the riwaq door at **−0.02** (a 15 mm threshold, R-08), falling **1 % away from the glass** across the floor to the kitchen wall foot at **−0.06**: no step, a 45 mm difference over the width that nobody feels.
- **Linear drains:** a slot drain with a silt basket **along the kitchen wall foot** south of the enclosure (y 9.6–12.8, under the TV) takes the whole floor; a short slot drain **at the riwaq door's threshold** (wind-driven rain at the door); the enclosure's two basins drain into the wall-foot drain's pipe. **Overflow route:** a second gully at the south-east corner with its rim at **−0.03** (3 cm above the drain level, 1.5 cm below the glass level) on its own pipe: if the drains block, the water leaves before it reaches the glass. **Trap primers** on the drains (rarely used in a dry season).
- **Pipes:** east under the kitchen floor (invert −0.55 at the drains, 1 % fall) to the **east RAIN chamber** in the yard and the soakaway (`studies/site_plan.typ`, `studies/plumbing.typ`): **never into the foul system**. **Waterproofing:** one membrane over the whole courtyard slab (lowered 0.05 for the outdoor build-up), up 0.15 behind the glass plinths and the kitchen wall base; the enclosure's two basins tanked separately.
- **Engineer / MEP to confirm:** the slab recess for the planter (0.75), the drain and pipe sizes, the rain chamber and the soakaway.

6 · Dimensions (clear, between finished faces)

Item	m	Note
Courtyard clear, level	4.5 × 6.3	28.35 m²; axes 4.70 × 6.50; no step
Colonnade walkway	1.575 / 1.25	to the soffit edge / at C21–C22; kept free
Seating zone (level)	2.925 × 5.2	12.09 m² free of the enclosure; was 10.53 m² in the pit: **+1.56 m²**
Furniture	5 seats	a 3-seat sofa, two armchairs, a low table 0.8 × 0.5 all movable
Cleaning strips	0.6 S · 0.5 N · 0.8 E	at the living glass / the women's majlis glass / the kitchen wall in front of the grille
Enclosure	1.3 × 2.4	on the kitchen wall, y 7.1–9.5, in front of the sink window; walls 0.15
Planting basin (north)	1 × 1.05 × 0.7	rim +0.45 tree crown Ø1.8 at 3 m
Water trough (south, raised)	1 × 0.6 × 0.35	rim +0.95, water +0.85, lip +1.05 seen from the sink (sill +1.10)
TV	1.46 × 0.86	y 9.82–11.28, +0.60 … +1.46 per the chosen model
TV frame	1.7 inside, band 0.1	springing +1.50, crown +2.45, proud 0.06 0.7 from the window
Grille	1 × 0.35	y 10.05–11.05, +0.10 … +0.45 bottom 0.1 above the floor; 0.15 below the TV
Levels	−0.02 / −0.06	the glass lines / the kitchen wall foot; overflow rim −0.03 pipe invert −0.55

What changed on 3 Nov 2026 (owner) and where

- The step, the nosing, the riser light and the three built-in benches are **removed**; the floor is level; the furniture is movable. The enclosure left the north side (the women's majlis glass is free) for the kitchen wall in front of the sink window; the TV and its surround moved 0.05 m south, the grille with them (`studies/air_system.typ`). The data: `3d/character.yaml` `courtyard_layout` (built in the 3D: `character_3d.py`, checked in `check_3d.py`); the plan marks in `design_gf.typ`; the drains in `studies/plumbing.typ` (the rain system).

The 9 checks are listed with their pass line on page 1. Every size assumed; the owner chooses the furniture; the engineer and the MEP engineer confirm the recess, the drains and the pipes.